

Thailand

November 2026

1 – 14 NOVEMBER 2026

Bangkok · Chiang Mai · Krabi · Khao Sok · Bangkok

14 days, 13 nights, two travellers

Trip summary

November 1 — Sunday

BANGKOK

Sawatdee khrap — welcome to Thailand
EK374 arrives 07:35
Airport to the hotel
Check in — The Ritz-Carlton, Bangkok
Use The Edit benefits — this stay only
Wat Pho
Sunset on the Chao Phraya

November 2 — Monday

BANGKOK

Grand Palace & Wat Phra Kaew
Wat Arun
Optional — Jim Thompson House
Yaowarat after dark
The Ritz-Carlton, Bangkok

November 3 — Tuesday

BANGKOK → THE NIGHT TRAIN

Optional — Floating market, or a food tour — not both
Ask for late check-out
Special Express #9 — 18:40 to Chiang Mai

November 4 — Wednesday

CHIANG MAI

Arrive Chiang Mai 07:15
Check in — U Chiang Mai
The Old City on foot
Night Bazaar and khao soi

November 5 — Thursday

CHIANG MAI

Ethical elephant sanctuary — NOT YET BOOKED
Nimman in the evening
U Chiang Mai

November 6 — Friday

CHIANG MAI

Wat Phra That Doi Suthep
The Old City, slowly
Optional — Or swap the whole day for Doi Inthanon
Repack tonight

November 7 — Saturday

KRABI

FD3072 — Chiang Mai 07:55 → Krabi 09:55
Krabi airport to Ao Nang
Check in — Centara Ao Nang Beach Resort & Spa
First Andaman sunset

November 8 — Sunday

KRABI

Island-hopping — not booked
The most weather-dependent day of the trip
Reef-safe sunscreen

November 9 — Monday

KRABI

Optional — Tiger Cave Temple at sunrise
Optional — Emerald Pool & hot springs
Long drive tomorrow

November 10 — Tuesday

KHAO SOK

Leave Krabi by 09:00
Longtail across Cheow Lan Lake — 12:00
THB 340 each, in cash
Check in — 360° Issara Floating Resort
Wildlife safari & sunset cruise — 17:00

November 11 — Wednesday

KHAO SOK

Pakarang Cave Trail — 09:45
Then nothing at all

November 12 — Thursday

KHAO SOK

Morning on the lake
Prakai Petch Cave Trail — confirm this one
Last sunset cruise — 17:00
Pack tonight

November 13 — Friday

KHAO SOK → BANGKOK

Check out 10:00, boat out at 10:30
Chiew Larn to Surat Thani
SL741 — Surat Thani 16:40 → Don Mueang 17:55
Into the city by rail, not road
Check in — Grande Centre Point Terminal 21

November 14 — Saturday

BANGKOK → HOME

A half day, not a full one
Leave by 17:00 — and mind the airport
EK373 — 20:45 to Dubai, then JFK
Chok dee

Information & documents

Everything below is either a number you might need in a hurry or a thing that is easy to forget on the day. The day-by-day pages follow.

Using this document

Keep it on your phone; you do not need to print the confirmations. Your name and the confirmation number are enough at every hotel. Every booking reference in this document also appears on the published itinerary at the download link, so either will do at a desk.

Emergency numbers — Thailand

All emergencies	191
Medical / ambulance	1669
Tourist police	1155 — English-speaking

Suppliers

For anything urgent on the day, call the operator directly rather than the agent — it is faster.

360° Issara	+66 2 474 0360
Thai Lion Air	+66 2 529 9999
Chase Travel	1-855-234-2542 — Ritz-Carlton, U Chiang Mai, Centara

Travel insurance

A Berkshire Hathaway Travel Protection policy covering this trip is in place; the policy document and number are in the trip email thread. Worth having the number to hand before you fly rather than hunting for it from a boat.

Weather and conditions

Early November is the front edge of the cool, dry season, but it is a front edge rather than a guarantee. The Andaman is still drying out — expect a wet afternoon or two around Krabi, and treat the island-hopping day as the one to move. Khao Sok is at its lushest precisely because the rain has only just stopped. Sea state is the thing that cancels boat trips, so ask at the hotel desk the evening before rather than the morning of.

Cash

Card works nearly everywhere, but two things on this trip are cash-only and both are at Khao Sok: the national park fee of **THB 340 per person** on arrival, and **THB 200 each** for the Pakarang cave trail. Draw that before you leave Krabi — there is no ATM on the lake.

Still to book

Every night and every flight is confirmed. No activity is: the elephant sanctuary on the 5th is the one to arrange first, as places sell out in season. The island-hopping boat on the 8th, Tiger Cave or the Emerald Pool on the 9th, and the two cave trails at Khao Sok can all be arranged locally — but the cave trails have fixed departure times and run only on certain days.

Day by day

November 1 — Sunday

BANGKOK



Sawatdee khrap — welcome to Thailand

You land at Suvarnabhumi after roughly 21 hours in transit and a 12-hour time shift. Take it gently; the day is built to be abandoned if you need to sleep.



EK374 arrives 07:35

Dubai → Bangkok Suvarnabhumi (BKK), Airbus A380. Booking reference **H2M5FJ**.



Airport to the hotel

Clear immigration, then the **Airport Rail Link to Makkasan** and the MRT one stop pattern to **Lumphini**. That exit is about 300 m from the door — noticeably better with cases than walking from Ploen Chit.



Check in — The Ritz-Carlton, Bangkok

Confirmation **90034653** · 2 nights · Deluxe Room, 1 King, Park View. Standard check-in is 15:00, but early check-in is one of your Edit benefits — ask at the desk. If the room isn't ready, leave the bags and start the day anyway.



Use The Edit benefits — this stay only

Booking through The Edit includes **breakfast for two daily**, a **USD 100 property credit** (once per stay, not against room rate, tax or gratuities), a welcome amenity, Wi-Fi, and a room upgrade plus early check-in and late check-out, all subject to availability. None of it is applied automatically — ask for each. U Chiang Mai and Centara were booked through Chase Travel too, but neither carries these.



Wat Pho

The reclining Buddha, 46 m of gilded plaster, and the country's oldest centre of massage teaching. A foot massage at the temple's own school is the correct way to spend the first afternoon.



Sunset on the Chao Phraya

A boat as the light goes, then a riverside dinner with **Wat Arun** lit across the water. Early night — you'll have earned it.

November 2 — Monday

BANGKOK



Grand Palace & Wat Phra Kaew

Be there at opening. The Emerald Buddha sits in the royal chapel; the complex is the single most crowded thing you will do all fortnight, and the heat compounds it. Shoulders and knees covered.



Wat Arun

Cross by ferry. Climb the central prang for the view back over the river.



Optional — Jim Thompson House

Six teak houses assembled by the American who rebuilt the Thai silk trade and then vanished in the Malaysian jungle in 1967. A cool, shaded hour.



Yaowarat after dark

Chinatown's street-food stretch. Go hungry and eat standing up.



The Ritz-Carlton, Bangkok

Second night. Breakfast for two is included — it is an Edit benefit, not a room-rate inclusion, so mention it.

November 3 — Tuesday

BANGKOK → THE NIGHT TRAIN



Optional — Floating market, or a food tour — not both

The **Maeklong railway market** and **Damnoen Saduak** are 80–100 km southwest and the market is finished by late morning, so those half-days leave the city around 06:30. If that's too early after two days of jet lag, take a slow morning and a guided food tour instead.



Ask for late check-out

An Edit benefit, and worth claiming: a shower before thirteen hours in a sleeper berth is not nothing. Pack an overnight bag you can actually reach from the berth.



Special Express #9 — 18:40 to Chiang Mai

Krung Thep Aphiwat (KTW) 18:40 → Chiang Mai (CGM) 07:15 next morning. Roughly 13 hours, 751 km. Two 2nd-class A/C sleeper berths, reservation **34511470**, e-tickets issued. **Be at the station by 18:10**. Dinner in the dining car, then berths down.

November 4 — Wednesday

CHIANG MAI



Arrive Chiang Mai 07:15

Thirteen hours north and about six degrees cooler.



Check in — U Chiang Mai

Confirmation **2535552787** · Deluxe with Bathtub, 1 King, inside the moat. **The room is held from the 3rd**, the night you were on the train — paid deliberately so it is yours the moment you step off the sleeper, whatever the train does. Non-refundable. Breakfast is extra, about **THB 399** each.



The Old City on foot

Wat Chedi Luang, whose 15th-century chedi lost its top thirty metres to an earthquake, and **Wat Phra Singh**. The quiet lanes between the two are the actual pleasure.



Night Bazaar and khao soi

The north's signature dish: egg noodles in a coconut curry broth, crisp noodles on top, pickled mustard greens and lime alongside.

November 5 — Thursday

CHIANG MAI



Ethical elephant sanctuary — NOT YET BOOKED

A full day at a genuine sanctuary — Elephant Nature Park or similar. Feeding and observing, no riding, no bathing circus. **This is the one thing to lock in first:** places sell out in season, and it is the centrepiece of the day.



Nimman in the evening

The café and craft-beer district west of the moat. Where Chiang Mai goes when it isn't being a temple town.



U Chiang Mai

November 6 — Friday

CHIANG MAI



Wat Phra That Doi Suthep

The gold chedi on the mountain above the city, reached by 306 steps flanked by naga balustrades. Morning, before the haze and the coaches.



The Old City, slowly

A market, a massage, one more bowl of khao soi.



Optional — Or swap the whole day for Doi Inthanon

Thailand's highest peak, with waterfalls and the twin royal chedis. But treat it as a **full day**: it is 2-2½ hours each way, in the opposite direction from Doi Suthep. You would leave about 07:00 and skip the temple. It does not fit as an afternoon.



Repack tonight

Tomorrow starts early — you are away from the hotel by about 06:00.

November 7 — Saturday

KRABI



FD3072 — Chiang Mai 07:55 → Krabi 09:55

Thai AirAsia, A320, non-stop. Booking **UYTUHF**. Roughly two hours in the air.



Krabi airport to Ao Nang

About 30 minutes.



Check in — Centara Ao Nang Beach Resort & Spa

Confirmation **2535573436** · 3 nights · Deluxe Room, 1 King, Pool Access. **You land well before check-in at 15:00** — leave the bags at reception and start on the beach. Two things to ask for on arrival: a room **away from the drainage canal** that runs between the wings, which is a recurring smell complaint, and confirmation of the pool-access room you paid for. Non-refundable; breakfast extra, around **THB 325–650** each.



First Andaman sunset

Afternoon on the sand, then a long seafood dinner.

November 8 — Sunday

KRABI



Island-hopping — not booked

A full day by boat: the **Hong Islands** lagoon, or the classic **4-Islands** route taking in Phra Nang cave beach, Tup, Chicken and Poda. Longtails leave from the Ao Nang beach pier, about ten minutes' walk. Book locally the day before.



The most weather-dependent day of the trip

Early-November seas are still unsettled and boat trips are the first thing cancelled. If it's rough, swap with tomorrow and do the inland day instead — that flexibility is the whole reason these two days sit next to each other.



Reef-safe sunscreen

Oxybenzone sunscreens are banned in Thai marine national parks.

November 9 — Monday

KRABI



Optional — Tiger Cave Temple at sunrise

1,260 steps to the summit shrine and a view over the whole Krabi plain. Brutal in the heat, which is the argument for going at dawn.



Optional — Emerald Pool & hot springs

Inland, in rainforest — a spring-fed pool the colour of its name and a set of warm cascades. The gentler alternative to the steps; easy afternoon back at the beach.



Long drive tomorrow

Repack tonight and keep one small bag accessible — you climb down stairs into a boat tomorrow and the big cases can stay at the pier office.

November 10 — Tuesday

KHAO SOK



Leave Krabi by 09:00

About **2 hours by road** to the 500Rai Pier Office at Chiew Larn. The private car is included in the resort package. Leave early enough for slack at the pier — you need to pay the park fee and get bags down to the boat before it goes, not arrive dead on the hour.



Longtail across Cheow Lan Lake — 12:00

About **1.5 hours**, sightseeing on the way, and the resort appears like a floating village under the karsts. Boats out to the resort leave the pier at **12:00 or 15:30 only**. Miss the 12:00 and you arrive after the sunset cruise below.



THB 340 each, in cash

The national park fee, payable on arrival and not included in the package. Bring it in cash.



Check in — 360° Issara Floating Resort

Booking **0592406** · 3 nights · the 3-Night Essence package, all-in. Check-in from 14:00. **Air-conditioning runs 12:00–06:00 only**, and that applies to all three nights.



Wildlife safari & sunset cruise — 17:00

Included. Swim off the deck first; set dinner is served over the water.

November 11 — Wednesday

KHAO SOK



Pakarang Cave Trail — 09:45

The one fixed thing today: a 1.5 km trek plus a bamboo raft. **THB 200 each, cash**, not included.



Then nothing at all

Kayak straight off your own balcony — every room has one. Swim in the fresh water, read, watch the light move across the karsts. This is the day the trip is built around.

November 12 — Thursday

KHAO SOK



Morning on the lake

Sightseeing along the shoreline — gibbons, hornbills, and elephants if you are lucky.



Prakai Petch Cave Trail — confirm this one

Swamp forest, small waterfalls and a glittering cave. The resort lists it as running **Mon / Wed / Sat**, and the 12th is a **Thursday** — so confirm it on arrival rather than counting on it. The morning lake trip above is the fallback.



Last sunset cruise — 17:00



Pack tonight

Check-out is 10:00 and tomorrow is the tightest day of the trip.

November 13 — Friday

KHAO SOK → BANGKOK



Check out 10:00, boat out at 10:30

This is the only scheduled boat back. It feeds a non-refundable flight the same afternoon, so reconfirm it with the resort the day before and don't plan on arranging something later.



Chiew Larn to Surat Thani

At the airport (URT) around 13:00, which leaves roughly three and a half hours in hand.



SL741 — Surat Thani 16:40 → Don Mueang 17:55

Thai Lion Air, arriving **Terminal 2**. Reservation code **0WUPXU**. Note this is **Don Mueang, not Suvarnabhumi**.



Into the city by rail, not road

Take the **SRT Red Line** to Krung Thep Aphiwat, then the MRT to Sukhumvit. It's a Friday and the roads will be at their worst; the train is elevated and ignores them. Reckon on being checked in around 19:00–19:30.



Check in — Grande Centre Point Terminal 21

Travelocity itinerary **73523066938869** · 1 night · Executive Suite for two. The hotel sits on top of the Asok interchange, so dinner is downstairs. Non-refundable.

November 14 — Saturday

BANGKOK → HOME



A half day, not a full one

Check out at 12:00 and leave the bags at the desk. You have about five hours, so keep it central — **ICONSIAM**, Jim Thompson House, a last massage. Not Ayutthaya; it needs the better part of a day.



Leave by 17:00 — and mind the airport

You arrived at **Don Mueang** yesterday but fly home from **Suvarnabhumi**. They are 50 km apart. From Asok it is one MRT stop to Phetchaburi and straight onto the **Airport Rail Link at Makkasan** — about 30 minutes, and no traffic to allow for.



EK373 — 20:45 to Dubai, then JFK

Suvarnabhumi 20:45 → Dubai, connecting to New York JFK at 08:15 Sunday. Booking **H2M5FJ**. At the airport by about 17:45.



Chok dee

Fourteen days, thirteen nights, five bases and four ways of travelling between them. Safe flight home.

Bookings & references

Every confirmed booking, in trip order. Name and reference are sufficient at check-in.

FLIGHTS — INTERNATIONAL

CONFIRMED • SEATS PURCHASED

Emirates

H2M5FJ Out 30 Oct • back 14 Nov

EK202 JFK 19:45 → Dubai · EK374 Dubai → Bangkok, arrives 07:35 on 1 Nov. Returning EK373 Bangkok 20:45 on 14 Nov → Dubai → JFK 08:15 on the 15th. Economy, both passengers, A380 on the Bangkok legs.

HOTEL — BANGKOK

CONFIRMED • PAID

The Ritz-Carlton, Bangkok

90034653 1–3 Nov • 2 nights

Deluxe Room, 1 King Bed, Park View. Booked through Chase Travel (Trip 1027840438) under The Edit: breakfast for two daily, USD 100 property credit, welcome amenity, Wi-Fi, and upgrade / early check-in / late check-out subject to availability.

RAIL — BANGKOK TO CHIANG MAI

TICKETED

State Railway of Thailand

34511470 3 Nov • 18:40 → 07:15

Special Express #9, two 2nd-class A/C sleeper berths. Krung Thep Aphiwat (KTW) to Chiang Mai (CGM), about 13 hours. E-tickets issued; be at the station by 18:10.

HOTEL — CHIANG MAI

CONFIRMED • NON-REFUNDABLE

U Chiang Mai

2535552787 3–7 Nov • room held from the 3rd

Deluxe with Bathtub, 1 King, two guests. Booked through Chase Travel (Trip 1027896876). The night of the 3rd is paid deliberately so the room is available on arrival at 07:15 on the 4th. Breakfast not included, about THB 399 each.

FLIGHT — CHIANG MAI TO KRABI

CONFIRMED

Thai AirAsia

UYTUHF 7 Nov • 07:55 → 09:55

FD3072, Airbus A320, non-stop. Both passengers.

HOTEL — KRABI

CONFIRMED • NON-REFUNDABLE

Centara Ao Nang Beach Resort & Spa

2535573436 7-10 Nov • 3 nights

Deluxe Room, 1 King Bed, Pool Access. Booked through Chase Travel (Trip 1027898679). Check-in 15:00, check-out 12:00. Ask for a room away from the drainage canal. Breakfast extra, THB 325-650 each.

RESORT — KHAO SOK

CONFIRMED • TRANSFERS INCLUDED

360° Issara Floating Resort

0592406 10-13 Nov • 3 nights

3-Night Essence package, all-inclusive. Private car from Krabi and the longtail transfer are both included. Boats to the resort leave Chiew Larn at 12:00 or 15:30 only; the return boat is 10:30. THB 340 each in cash for the national park fee. A/C runs 12:00-06:00.

FLIGHT — SURAT THANI TO BANGKOK

CONFIRMED

Thai Lion Air

OWUPXU 13 Nov • 16:40 → 17:55

SL741, arriving Don Mueang (DMK) Terminal 2 — not Suvarnabhumi. Both passengers ticketed; check-in required.

HOTEL — BANGKOK

CONFIRMED • NON-REFUNDABLE

Grande Centre Point Terminal 21

73523066938869 13-14 Nov • 1 night

Executive Suite for two, on the Asok interchange. Booked through Travelocity. Check-in from 14:00, check-out 12:00. The card used to book must be presented at check-in with matching photo ID.